In the same vein, we can exclude some fields while returning the response by using the `_source_excludes` parameter.

#### Excluding fields using _source_excludes

We can exclude fields we don't want to be returned in the response using the `_source_excludes` parameter. It is a URL path parameter that accepts comma-separated fields. The response consists of all the document fields minus the fields mentioned in the `_source_excludes` parameter.

**Listing 5.17 Excluding the fields in response**

```
GET movies/_source/3?_source_excludes=actors,synopsis
```

Here, the `actors` and `synopsis` fields are excluded from the response. What if we want to include some fields and explicitly exclude some fields too? Can an Elasticsearch query support this functionality? Sure—we can ask Elasticsearch to satisfy these requirements, as discussed in the next section.

#### Including and excluding fields

We can mix and match the return attributes we want, because Elasticsearch allows us to fine-tune the response. To demonstrate, let's create a new `movie` document with various ratings (`amazon`, `metacritic`, and `rotten_tomatoes`).

**Listing 5.18 New movie model with ratings**

```
PUT movies/_doc/13
{
  "title":"Avatar",
  "rating":9.3,
  "rating_amazon":4.5,
  "rating_rotten_tomatoes":80,
  "rating_metacritic":90
}
```

How can we return all the ratings except `amazon`? Here's where the power shines of setting up `_source_includes` and `_source_excludes` with appropriate attributes.

**Listing 5.19 Selectively ignoring certain fields**

```
GET movies/_source/13?_source_includes=rating*&_source_excludes=rating_amazon
```

The query and response are shown in figure 5.11.

In this query, we enable a wildcard field, `_source_includes=rating*`, to fetch all the attributes prefixed with the word *rating* (`rating`, `rating_amazon`, `rating_metacritic`, `rating_rotten_tomatoes`). The `_source_excludes` parameter, on the other hand, suppresses a field (for example, `_source_excludes=rating_amazon`). The resultant document should consist of all the ratings except the Amazon rating.